

Interference tactics: White, move 13

Interference tactics

White to move

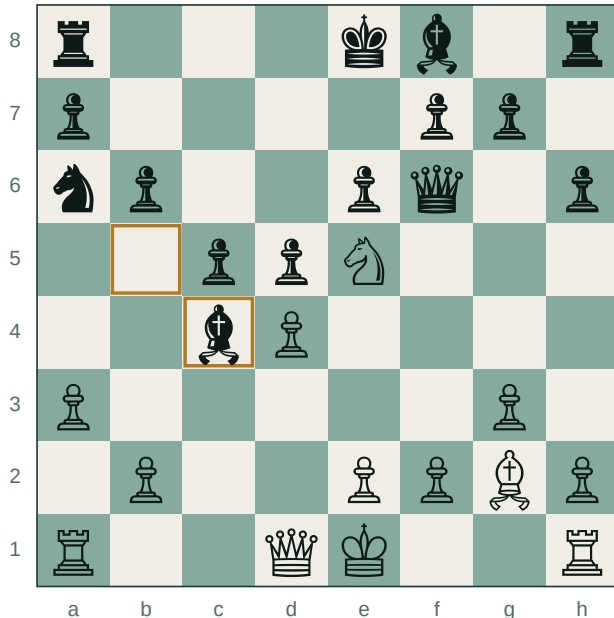
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.



Previous move: 12...Bxc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13. Qa4+ b5 14. Qxa6

13.Qa4+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From a4 it attacks king on e8, knight on a6 and bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **13...b5**.

14.Qxa6 The queen captures the knight on a6.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -4 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.